

XFX 8800GTS Alpha Dog Edition

Pull Her Dog Tags Mate...

XFx's "serious gamer" Alpha Dog Edition is here, featuring all the 128 shader units it's supposed to. The only thing distinguishing it from the GTX / Ultra models is the 256-bit memory interface.

The card features a core factory overclocked to 678 MHz (the default Core is 650 MHz), and here's where the fun begins—the core is now faster than an 8800GTX, and the scores show it. Shader clocks are also up to 1700 MHz from the default of 1625 MHz. Of course, the 8800GTS Alpha Dog still has the restriction of 16 ROPs (Raster Operations), as opposed to the 24 ROPs on the GTX / Ultra cards.

Nevertheless, this card has some serious horsepower, and runs

noticeably cooler than the 8800GTX and Ultra cards; it's a lot shorter, too—9.5 inches opposed to 11 inches on the older cards. Priced lower than its older sibling, running cooler and basically having less power requirements seems like the XFX 8800GTS 512 Alpha Dog Edition has all the accolades in its kitty.

Lost Planet is a sweet bundle. At Rs 25,000, the XFX is costly now. Yes, it's around Rs 5,000 cheaper than the cheapest 8800GTX, but the new 8800GT core changes things considerably. Eighty-five per cent of the performance at nearly half the price! This card is a mite too expensive to be of any use to the discerning gamer who will likely buy two 8800GTs for a little



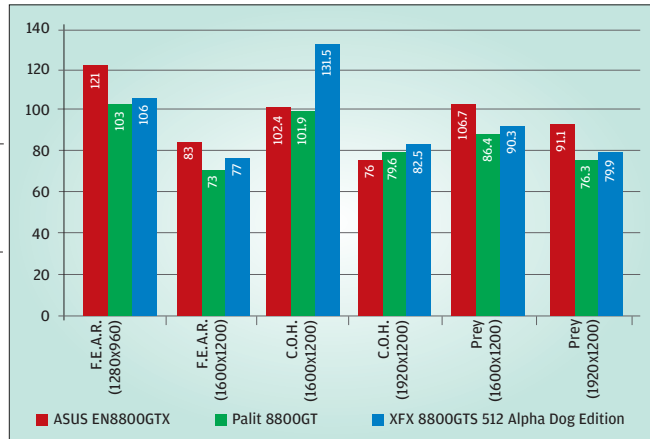
more than the price of a single 8800GTS, and use them in an SLI setup.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

128 Shader Units; Core Speed: 678 MHz; Memory: 2,000 MHz; Memory Bus: 256 bits

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-67090909
E-mail: xfx@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.xfxforce.com
Price: Rs 25,000



Palit 8800GT 512 Sonic

Sonic Boom!

The 8800GT Sonic utilises a very simple and radically different cooler from the stock NVIDIA cooler, and isn't bad for it. Though not as attractive, a simple circular heatsink and

Palit has really got the Sonic's thermals spot on! *Tomb Raider Anniversary* is bundled—sweet for all the Lara Croft fans floating around.

The 8800GT Sonic proved



a large embedded fan do get the job done better. The heatsink extends to strips that run over the memory chips, passively cooling them. Temperatures are around 15 degrees less than the stock cooler, meaning

to be a pleasure to test. It comes really close to embarrassing its older siblings at half the price, even less. For reference, we're throwing in our stock 8800GTX for a real comparison. We've used the

highest settings that gamers are generally likely to use—4x AntiAliasing and 8x Anisotropic Filtering have been enabled; all other settings are at their maximum values.

Priced at Rs 14,750 (chances are you'll get this card a bit lower on the street), the Palit 8800GT Sonic is an impressive offering that delivers performance with a cool head. If you're looking for a fast DX 10 card, buy the

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

8800GT Sonic without any qualms—we guarantee satisfaction. If you're the kind who wants to run games at maximum detail, invest in an SLI board and pick up two of these.

Specifications

112 Shader Units; Core Speed: 600 MHz; Memory: 512 MB; 1800 MHz; Bus Width: 256-bit

Contact: Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23828100 / 23823100 / 011-26293001 / 3002
E-mail: dinesh@mediamangroup.com / himanshu@amigointernational.biz
Web site: www.palit.biz/en/
Price: Rs 14,750

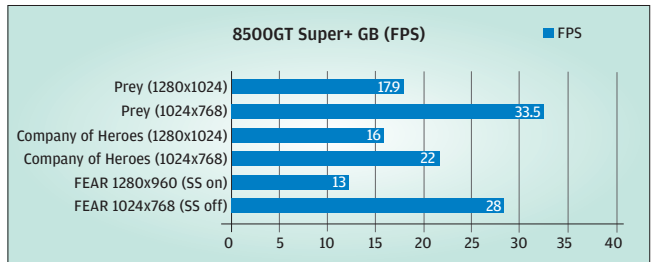
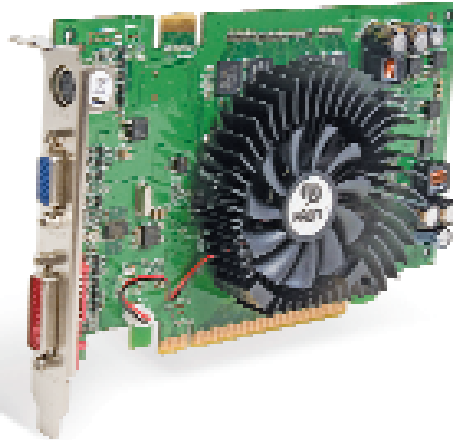
Palit 8500GT Super+ 1GB

1 Gig Too Much?

The first time we saw the 1 GB badge on the Palit 8500GT, we did a double-take to make sure—this is a lot of memory to waste on a core that has 16 stream processors (half the number on the 8600GT). We figure half this memory will just be sitting around doing nothing—after all, we've

seen most 8600GTs with 256 MB of memory working fine with huge textures.

The card does with a minimal cooling setup—circular heatsink with an embedded fan—but then the 8500GT is a very cool customer. Benchmarking the Palit 8500GT showed us that our initial reactions



were right. The Core doesn't really have enough horsepower to keep all that memory busy. However, at higher resolutions we were able to get a couple of extra frames compared to other 8500GT cards.

Rs 5,250 doesn't seem much for a 1 GB card, but an 8600GT will outperform the Palit 8500GT Super+ by around 200 percent and

cost just Rs 1,500 more. We wouldn't recommend this card to a gamer, and neither to someone looking for an HTPC. Look for 256 MB of RAM—its all you'll need in this category.

Specifications

GF 8500GT chipset; 16 Shader Units; Core: 450 MHz; Memory: 800 MHz; 1 GB video memory

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23828100 / 23823100 / 011-26293001 / 3002
E-mail: dinesh@mediamangroup.com / himanshu@amigointernational.biz
Web site: www.palit.biz/en/
Price: Rs 5,250

BrowseControl 3.1

Basic Network Administrating Utility For The Cyber-Café Owner

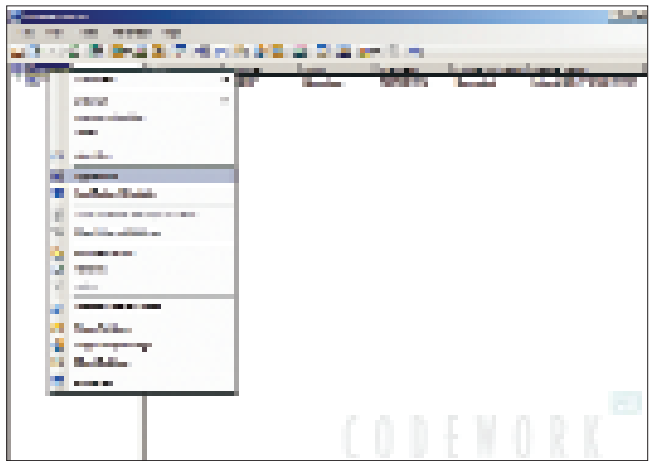
BrowseControl is an Internet management tool with an easy to use interface that gives you real-time control over multiple computers on a network. The installation is rather simple—you first need to install the package on the machine that will be the main machine. The client installer can be installed over the network or manually by installing the program on every client machine.

Client machines are assigned to groups, and permissions for groups can be set, which will affect all the machines in that group. This way, you can allot all members of a team in one group and give suitable permissions to each group depending on requirements. Most of the features and permissions are (obviously) to do with the access to Internet sites. Access to sites and permissions to down-

loading certain file formats can be denied. Other than that, external storage devices like CD/DVD drives and USB drives can be disabled by a couple of clicks. Machines can also be forcibly shut down.

An interesting thing with BrowseControl is that there are no traces of the software running, so users on the client machine will find it a bit difficult to bypass the software. The other good thing with BrowseControl is that it allows you to set multiple time schedules for pretty much everything—you can even ensure that certain programs cannot be run during the day, for example.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



This software is fairly easy to use and the Windows help file is there for those who still need it. It has a good explanation of all the features along with screenshots making it even easier.

BrowseControl would be perfectly fine for cyber-cafés or smaller educational institutions. It can also be implemented in bigger offices

where strict Internet access permissions need to be implemented.

Specifications

Requires Windows 2000 / 2003 / XP / Vista

Contact: Codework Solutions Pvt Ltd
Phone: 0484-4055678
E-mail: india@codework.com
Web site: www.browsecontrol.com
Price: Rs 1,001; 5-user: Rs 2,761